packages else where. The company has a policy of talking to people who plan to quit and in many cases, it manages to work out a win-win situation.

M & S realises that to hold on to the position as a preferred employer. It will have to continue tweaking its HR policies to counter stiff competition for talent from its bigger rivals.

Questions

Q. 1. What makes M and S one of the most sought after employers ?

Q. 2. Does a 360 degree appraisal really help ?

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MBA (3rd Semester)

Examination, Nov.-Dec., 2014

Branch : Management

HUMAN RESOURCES PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT (NEW)

Time Allowed : Three Hours

Maximum Marks : 80

Minimum Pass Marks : 32

Note : All the parts carry equal marks. Part E is compulsory.

Part-A (Any two)

Q. 1. 'Human resource is the total knowledge, abilities and skill, talents and aptitude of an organisation's workforce'. Discuss.

Q. 2. Discuss why has human resource management become an all pervasive function in organisation's today.

Q. 3. 'Manpower planning is an integral part of an organisation's strategy'. Discuss.

Q. 4. Write short notes on :

(1) Work Measurement

(2) Work Study

Part-B (Any two)

Q. 1. 'The logical approach of staffing begins with a careful assessment of the current and planning prespective requirements of human resource'. Comment.

Q. 2. Explain the application of Job Analysis in the efficient management of human resources.

Q. 3. Imagine that a key employee has just resigned and you are the department manager. After you have sent a request for replacement how would you help the recruiter to find the best replacement.

Q. 4. 'Campus recruitment is often an expensive process'. Comment and compare it with other external sources of recruitment.

Part-C (Any two)

Q. 1. What are the likely outcomes of human resource development mechanism on individual performance and group performance.

Q. 2. Discuss certain strategies to cope with organisational role stress.

Q. 3. Explain the various instruments of HRD. Discuss the essentials of effective HRD in industrial organisations.

Q. 4. Write a detailed note on HRD in Indian industry.

Part-D (Any four)

Discuss

Q. 1. HRD is Defence.

Q. 2. HRD is Manufacturing Organisations

Q. 3. HRD is Govt. and Private Systems

Q. 4. HRD Audit,

Q. 5. Changing Environment of HRD.

Part-E (Compulsory)

Analyse and discuss the given case.

EMPLOYEE EMPOWERMENT

M & S company can boost of its employee empowerment practices. The company is a technology consultancy firm. It is a purpose-vision and core value driven organisation which facilitates the development of a person's full potential. It gives its employees an environment of freedom, flexibility and trust and this is what engenders loyality. The company's approach requires a high degree of cultural alignment across teams and thrives on strong values shared by colleagues across the globe, transparency and a strong leadership. Instead of having a HR manager the company has a People's Strategy Manager. According to Binoo Dhingra, Director (People's Strategy), "we give individuals lots of responsibility and freedom. This empowers them and provides them with both the opportunity and the platform to grow."

The company emphasises the importance of teamwork and has the system of providing feedback at every stage. Designations hold little meaning in the company. People who display potential and spunk are often entrusted with the role of project managers.

The filtering process of the employees starts at then recruitment stage itself. Employees are ranked not on the basis of their domain skills only but on whether they possess the values that are core to M & S and whether this is exhibited in their behaviour. The process of integrating new recruits into M & S also starts at this stage. Once selected, the candidates are given an overview of the company's business. Once they join, they have to undergo an induction programme that gives them an understanding of the company's culture and their role within the organisation. Following the induction process, the employees are assigned a coach or a career manager, who are top or senior managers. The role of these mentors is to help them define their career goals and chalk out a viable growth path.

The company has a 360° performance appraisal system. Employees are rated not only by their superiors but also by their peers and even by their subordinates. This minimises if not cuts down, the possibility of biasness or favouritism creeping into the process. Promotions can happen anytime, even in six months, depending on performance. The company has a good reward system also compensation is often one of the most critical determinants of employee satisfaction. Barring the top 15% all other employee get a fixed salary, which is revised every year, a clear departure from an industry wise practice of offering as much as 30% variable compensation. The company believes that it is usually the top 15% employees whose decisions usually determine the profits of the company so why should those at the lower lends pay if profits dip. The company is however not a soft employer. It gives its employees enough room to experiment and learn and an underperforming employee is typically given three chances,

before being asked to move on. The company lays a huge premium on training its employees. It runs a virtual university, which takes care of all its training needs. People are also allowed to move across functional boundaries, take up international assignments (within the M & S fold) and constantly reinvent themselves by learning new skills. The company never holds back its employees' chances of moving to new locations, though this sometimes leads to work in India suffering as a result.

Further, the company takes pains to project itself as caring organisation. It helps the employees strike a balance between their professional and personal lives.

Despite its people friendly practices and the high praise heaped on it by employees, M & S has a global attrition rate of about 18% the Indian figure is even higher. Industry sources say that despite good HR policies many companies the losing people because they are being offered better pay